

The Boston Globe

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TUESDAY, JUNE 2, 2026

‘He was truly a light in this world.’

RODNEY MARSHALL, *Boston fire commissioner*



PHOTOS BY DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Funeral Mass at Cathedral of the Holy Cross Monday for Boston firefighter Robert T. Kilduff Jr.

FOR FIREFIGHTER, A FINAL SALUTE

Tributes at funeral recall an ardent supporter of family, comrades, community

By Lea Skene and Travis Andersen

GLOBE STAFF

They formed a sea of blue under gray skies.

Thousands of firefighters donned their navy dress uniforms on a cloudy Monday morning and poured into Boston’s South End, lining Washington Street ahead of a funeral Mass for their fallen brother, Robert T. “Bobby” Kilduff Jr. And when the time came, as the engine carrying his flag-draped casket proceeded slowly toward the church, they raised white-gloved hands in a silent, solemn salute.

It was a moving demonstration of respect and solidarity for someone widely remembered as the quintessential first responder.

FUNERAL, Page A10



Better under Breslow? Sox hopes, reality don’t match.

By Tim Healey

GLOBE STAFF

From his suite perched high above the field at Fenway Park, Craig Breslow watches it all.

On the mound, Sonny Gray and Ranger Suarez, veteran starting pitchers brought in to help turn a good rotation into an elite one, form a piece of the plan that has worked.

In the infield, Caleb Durbin, the Red Sox’ third third baseman in as many years, disappointing as a key part of Breslow’s signature trade tree.

In the dugout, an injured Roman Anthony, and at shortstop, Marcelo Mayer, two of the bally-hooded big three prospects who — a year after their debuts — have not performed to expectations.

More than ever, a month-plus after he fired manager Alex Cora and six coaches, and as another

BRESLOW, Page C2

In the wake of the hantavirus outbreak Influencer’s cruise turns into darker exploration of isolation

When Jake Rosmarin, 29, a Boston-based travel influencer, boarded the MV Hondius for a cruise from Argentina to Cape Verde, he had some 29,000 followers on TikTok and 43,000 on Instagram, and, eager to do his job and grow his following, he quickly got to work. He posted videos of hourglass dolphins cresting rolling seas. Of a sunset arching through the sky. And of himself, gushing about being the “first person ever” to drink a Bischoff vanilla iced latte at Tristan da Cunha, the remot-

est inhabited island in the world.

That was all in April.

In early May, after what at first seemed like the unfortunate but unrelated deaths of one, then two passengers (and eventually a third), the voyagers learned that the deaths were in fact related, and that the deadly hantavirus was stalking the ship.

On May 3, Rosmarin — a 2018 Emory University

INFLUENCER, Page A10

BETH TEITELL



STAN GROSSFELD/GLOBE STAFF

TAKE IT FROM THE TOP

Globe photographer Stan Grossfeld looks at life from up high — from Boston area parking garages. At left, the Boston Children’s Hospital garage has views of the skybridge and sidewalks that deliver patients to a place of hope. **B1.**

BMC faces double financial challenge

Hospital system posted \$41.7m in operating losses as Medicaid cuts loom

By Jonathan Saltzman

GLOBE STAFF

Boston Medical Center, the state’s largest provider of medical care to the poor, has a long history of weathering financial challenges. These days, the headwinds are particularly strong.

They blow largely because of BMC’s 2024 acquisition of two struggling community hospitals from Steward Health Care, the for-profit hospital chain that had stumbled into bankruptcy and made national headlines. Governor Maura Healey’s administration had urged BMC to make the acquisitions.

Steward had neglected its hospitals for years, and now those that survived are affecting the bottom lines of the health care systems that acquired them. Last month, BMC reported operating losses of \$41.7 million for the first six months of its fiscal year, worse than the \$30.4 million in losses for the same period the year before.

“They are hemorrhaging cash,” Gary Young, director of Northeastern University’s Center for Health Policy and Healthcare Research, said of the two hospitals acquired by BMC, the former St. Elizabeth’s Medical Center in Brighton and the former Good Samaritan Medical Center in Brockton.

The bleeding comes at a time when BMC, like many hospitals, is grappling with rising costs and is likely to face cuts in Medicaid funding next year. Experts predict the cuts will have an outsized impact on safety-net hospitals like BMC, where roughly 40 percent of patients are on Medicaid, the government insurer for low-income and disabled people.

The state earmarked about \$387 million over **BOSTON MEDICAL, Page A7**

Sheriffs’ offices like ‘wild west,’ report asserts

Watchdog says guidelines archaic, oversight lax

By Sean Cotter

GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts sheriffs are running their offices’ finances like the “wild west,” including millions of dollars passing through off-the-books bank accounts, illegal spending, and scant oversight, according to a scathing report released Monday by a state watchdog.

The Office of the Inspector General’s report calls for urgent action by state regulators to clean up what’s characterized as archaic, messy, and questionable spending practices across the state’s 14 county sheriffs’ offices, which oversee jails in Massachusetts.

One example of the potential illegal use of funds, the Office of the Inspector General wrote, is that the sheriffs collectively used more than 120 private bank accounts without proper state oversight. More than \$40 million passed through these accounts, according to the report, and it is unclear whether interest was sent back to the state’s general fund as mandated by law.

The report makes short-, medium-, and long-term recommendations aimed at providing more state oversight of offices that have increasingly run into trouble.

“It is time for the chaos to stop,” Inspector General Jeffrey S. Shapiro said in a statement. “The lack of a common understanding among sheriffs, lawmakers, and the Executive Office of Administration & Finance (A&F) on such foundational ideas as the role of the sheriff, what the state covers for mandated programs ... has resulted in uncontrolled spending with little to no oversight. To put it in sheriffs’ terms, it’s a bit like the wild west.”

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VOL. 309, NO. 153

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Suggested retail price
\$4.00



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Peek-a-blue Tue.

Tuesday: Some sun, warmer. High 70-75, low 55-60.

Wednesday: A bit more sun. High 71-76, low 57-62.

Weather and comics, **D5-6.** Obituaries, **C9.**

Patriots land star receiver

New England swapped draft choices to the Eagles for A.J. Brown (right). **C1.**



TERRANCE WILLIAMS/AP

Raymond Berry has died. A Hall of Famer as a player, he later put on the coach’s headset and led the Patriots to their first Super Bowl. **C1.**

President Trump stepped back from creating a \$1.8 billion fund to compensate allies. **A6.**